

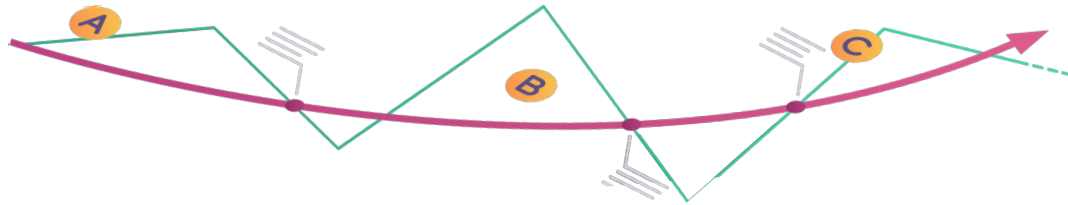


Vendor Benchmarking &
District Focus Analytics Platform



Vendor Benchmark Analysis

Research based approach leveraging business intelligence and comparative analytics to ensure vendor accountability.



Setting the Stage

375

District average active vendor contracts

70%

Vendor contracts renew annually - over summer (June, July, August)



Majority of which have been in place longer than admin responsible (inherited)

3-5_{yrs}

Initial contracts term - vendor preference - 5yrs ago > 2020 “Pandemic days”

100%

Districts will change, grow, and adapt to meet the needs of students

*Valuable historical lessons? Changes in staffing, leadership, initiative, funding...

*Vendors also change constantly - SIS Acquisition/PowerSchool Hack



How did we get here? (root cause analysis)

Systemic contract bloat is very common because of how the system was designed

Contributing Factors (symptoms)

- School happening = Constant change makes it difficult to look backwards
- K12 funding formula (future focused projections)
- Unnatural spending conditions (use it or lose it = FOMO/FORF Fear of Returning Funds)
- Compliance factors/mandated costs/encroachment
- One-time funding (invested in ongoing expenditures)
- **Vendors have asymmetrical incentives (income vs impact)**



Asymmetrical Incentives: Vendors Perspective

Education is a hyper-growth industry

- Projected to increase to \$421 billion by 2032. Up from 126B in 2022

More options > new vendors = New district leverage

Vendors constantly need new clients

- Cost less to retain a current client than the cost of acquiring a new client = New district leverage

Relevancy & Validation

- Vendors need you to validate their claims to sell to other districts (CUSD's logo on vendor site)

Stages of vendor lifecycle

- Startup > venture capital investment > private equity > public offering
- Every transition in the life cycle is an opportunity to reassess value and renegotiate



Program Objectives

- 1. Clarity** (Organize, benchmark, analyze)
- 2. Reduce Costs** (Decrease expenditures)
- 3. Lead with Data** (Unlocking efficiency, Reduce risk)



Value Delta: Usage + Fair Market Value

Question: Do we have anything in place currently that does...?

Baseline: How has the district changed in the past X years? (Example: reduced ADA by 6.5%)

- All contacts by category
- Filter by: Reading, Elem, software
- Result: IXL/Renaissance/Achieve 3000
- How long has each vendor been in place
- What is the contract history (total cost of ownership)
- How has our contract changed since inception (ref. 6.5% ADA reduction)
- Are we still paying fair market value for districts of like size
- Compare alternative vendors pricing to ensure vendor accountability



Roadmap: Getting Started

Phase 1: **Baseline contract topography**

- Analyze past 24 months of renewals
- Organize, sort, tag:
 - Category, price, duration, scope etc.
- Grade contracts: Keep Question Cut

Phase 2: **Identified savings: gaps, cracks, & overlaps**

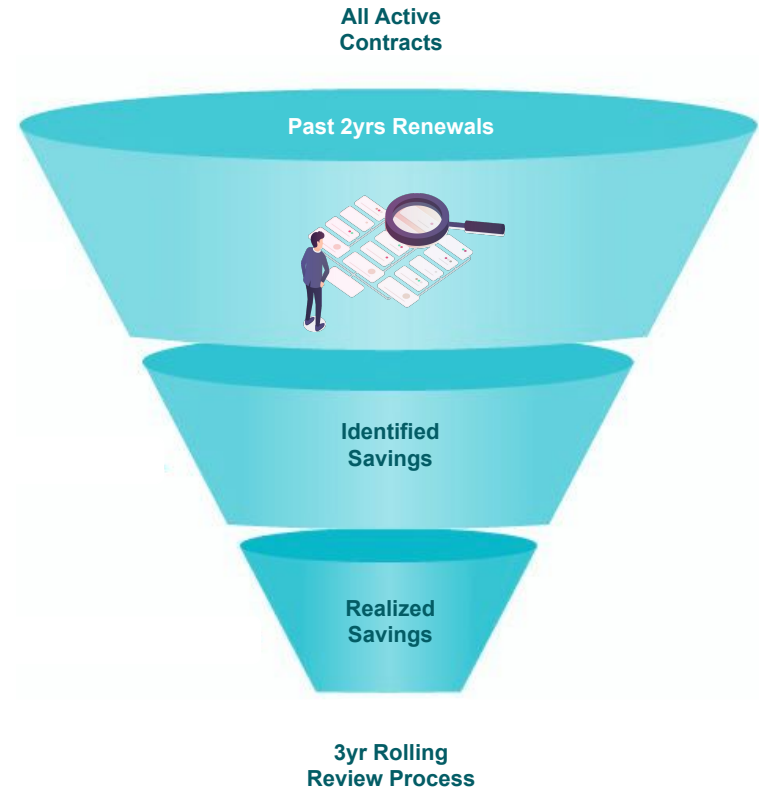
- Research and compare liksize districts' contracts
- Precision bidding to surface ideal competitive offering:
 - Company, product, price, scope, duration

Phase 3: **Realize savings**

- Consolidate vs Renegotiate

Phase 4: **Automate forward facing process**

- Validate: Qualification matrix, process and filters for all new contracts



Contract Intelligence Dashboard

Orange Unified School District - Real-time Contract Performance & Efficiency Analysis

DISTRICT TYPE

Unified K-12

ENROLLMENT

26,847

TOTAL STAFF

2,890

SCHOOL SITES

42

COUNTY

Orange

District Baseline Efficiency Score

Comprehensive efficiency rating based on spend-to-service ratio



Good - Above District Average

COST PER STUDENT

\$1,847

COST PER STAFF

\$17,162

COST PER SITE

\$1,180k

CONTRACT EFFICIENCY

78%

Efficiency Formula

Score = (Service Coverage × 30%) + (Cost Optimization × 25%) +
(Contract Utilization × 20%) + (Risk Management × 15%) +

\$49.6M

TOTAL ANNUAL SPEND

↓ 3.2% vs Target

184

ACTIVE VENDORS

12 Due Diligence Needed



237

TOTAL CONTRACTS

18 Expired

Critical Risk Alerts

Immediate attention required



18 Contracts Expired

Operating without valid agreements - \$3.2M in annual spend at risk

HIGH RISK



23 Contracts Expiring in 90 Days

\$8.7M in spend requires renewal negotiation

ACTION NEEDED



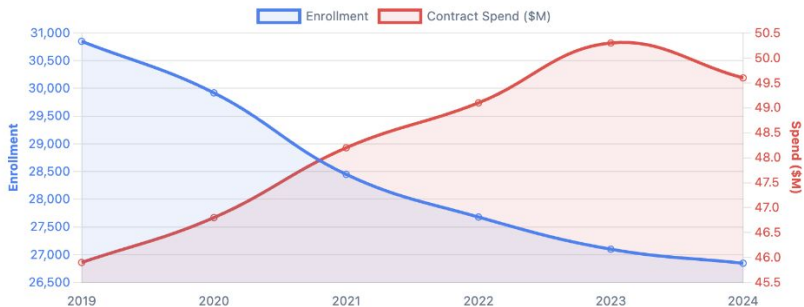
\$487K Savings Identified

9 contracts with renegotiation opportunities

OPPORTUNITY

Enrollment vs Contract Spend Analysis

Your contracts haven't adapted to your changing district



Key Insight

Enrollment decreased 13% since 2019, yet total contract spend increased 8%. You're paying for students you no longer serve - representing **\$2.1M in potential savings** through right-sizing.

District Comparative Performance Band

How your spend efficiency compares to similar districts



Peer District Average

\$1,923

Your Performance

4% Better

State Average (Unified K-12)

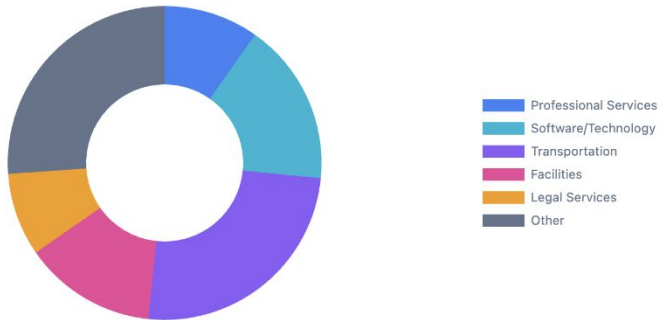
\$2,041

Optimal Target Range

\$1,600-\$1,800

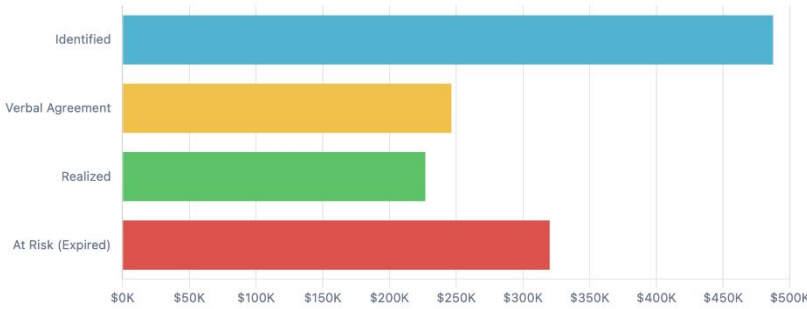
 Spend by Contract Category

Where your district dollars are going



 Savings Pipeline & Opportunities

Identified savings across contract lifecycle



 **Total Identified Savings: \$487,350**
ROI Impact: **\$3.90 per \$1 invested** in contract optimization

 All District Contracts - Performance View

Complete contract inventory sorted by annual spend

Vendor Name	Category	Annual Spend	Start Date	End Date	Years Active	Status	Risk Level	Savings Opp.
Chevron Energy Solutions	ESCO / Energy	\$2,850,000	Nov 2024	Oct 2025	1 year	Active	MEDIUM	\$142,500
First Student Inc	Transportation	\$945,000	Sep 2023	Aug 2026	3 years	Active	LOW	—
Kelly Educational Staffing	Substitute Staffing	\$580,000	Aug 2023	Aug 2025	2 years	Active	LOW	\$20,300
ADP TotalSource	Payroll & HR	\$420,000	Jul 2023	Jun 2026	3 years	Active	MEDIUM	\$84,000
Edison Assessment Services	Busch Services	\$295,000	Jul 2022	Jun 2024	1 year	Expired	HIGH	\$57,000

Sample Report: Online Speech Language Pathology

Vendors				
Price	\$519,000.00	\$378,925.00	\$399,000.00	\$384,800.00
Contract Uplift	NA	None	None	None
Contract Term	Annual	3-5 Year	Annual	Month-to-Month
Therapist/Caseload Continuity	NA	Team	Team	1 to1
Students Served	280	280	280	280
Therapy/Caseload Frequency	30min	30min	30min	30min
Assessment QTY	50	95	94	95
Active Dashboard(s)	NA	Yes	Report based	Report based
Medical Billing Support	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
User Experience: Support	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes
Reporting/Analytics	NA	Yes	Yes	Yes
Therapist experience	NA	3+	2+	3+
Company CA Certified	NA	Yes	Yes	Yes
Therapist CA Certified	NA	Yes	Yes	Yes
CA References	NA	2 CA (Very small)	3 CA / 2 non CA	2 CA (Very small)
Company Founded	2011	2009	2014	2005
Cancellation Terms	30-Day Notice	NA	30-Day Notice	90-Day Notice
Glass Door Ranking (Culture)	4.8	5	5	4.7



Sample Report: Print Managed Services - Vendor comparative grid

	Compton	Murrieta Valley	Vista Unified	Torrance
Current Contract Value	\$1,710,980.00	\$3,689,931.36	\$614,403.29	\$1,308,164
Annual Price	\$342,196.00	\$737,986.27	\$122,880.00	\$261,632
Vendor				
Sites	37	22	34	36
Students	19,179	23,251	24,198	22,490
Teachers	901	909	981	915
RFP utilized	no	no	yes	na
Contract term	5yr	5 years	5 years	5 years
Initial contract	2012	2014	2014	2020
Piggyback utilized	yes	no	no	yes
Contract utilized	MA-IS-1640250-3	-	-	C-4400003732
Initial Contract Value	\$2,022,067.00	-	\$791,448.24	-
Devices under managment	295	1681	635	1427

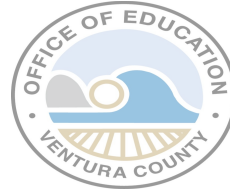
Thank You

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Our Journey



Axcient



2006

2025



Education Innovation and Research (EIR)

Enhancing educational equity and innovation

146B

Education Technology (EdTech) industry global sales revenue in 2023

421B

Global sales revenue projected to increase by 2033

82B

US EdTech 2023 revenue up from 36B billion in 2022

2,591

EdTech tools experimented with annually by districts

This allocation underscores a strategic approach towards accelerating academic recovery following the significant disruptions caused by the COVID-19 pandemic.



Baseline Questions

- Do you have a dashboard for all active vendor contracts?
- A dashboard that is intuitive and delivers actionable insights around:
 - Category, department, price, uplift %
 - Contract duration (gaps or overlap)
 - Total historical vendor spend
- Are your top 100, 50 or even 10 contracts:
 - Aligned to the current year district initiatives
 - At or below fair market value compared to likesize districts
 - Achieving impact
- If you had to cut \$5M, how long would it take to surface:
 - Underutilized contracts
 - Low impact contracts
 - Contracts over fair market value



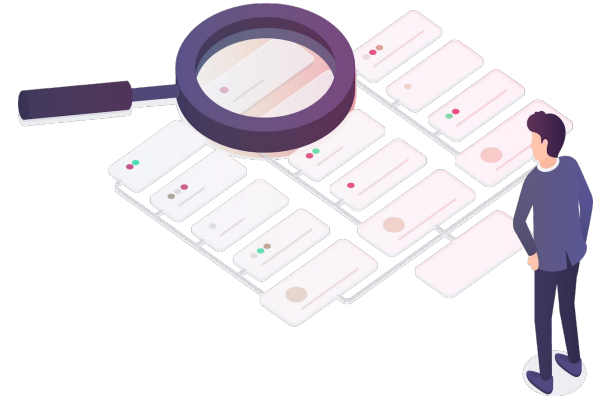


Founded in 2016, Fortify Partners is a professional services firm dedicated to empowering district leaders with advisement, actionable insights, and strategic solutions.

Phase 2: Identify Savings

Body of work to identify gaps, cracks, & overlaps via comparative analysis

- * **Who bought it?** (Incumbent decision maker of original sale/contract?)
 - * **Where are they now?** (Current employer, location, and current role?)
- * **Main internal influencer of contract?** (if different from above)
- * **Who implemented it?** (Original implementor assigned to project?)
- * **Was original contract language aligned to an initiative, program, or person?**
 - * Current program manager per contract? (Who oversees contract currently?)
 - * Align vendor usage reports with internal user feedback
 - * Determine which districts were referenced during evaluation



Additional Services & Data Studies

1) **School Board Collaboration & Strategy:**

Facilitating effective communication and strategic alignment between the superintendent's office and school board members, ensuring a unified vision and efficient governance.

2) **Labor Action & Strike Preparedness:**

Developing proactive strategies and comprehensive action plans to prepare for, mitigate, and effectively manage potential labor disputes or strikes, minimizing disruption and protecting district interests.

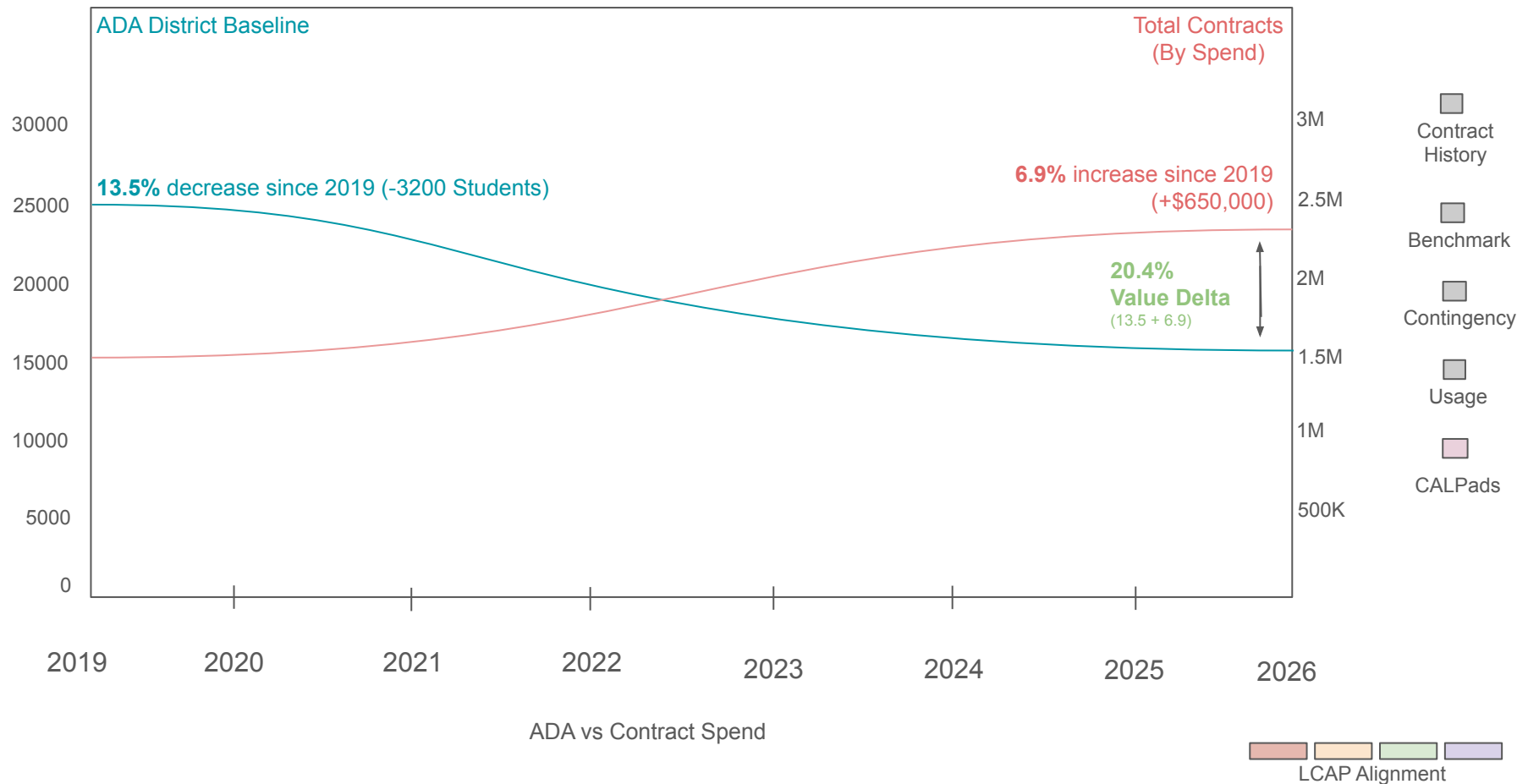
3) **Departmental Reviews & Operational Efficiency:**

Conducting impartial and thorough reviews of existing departments to identify areas for improvement, streamline operations, and enhance overall effectiveness.

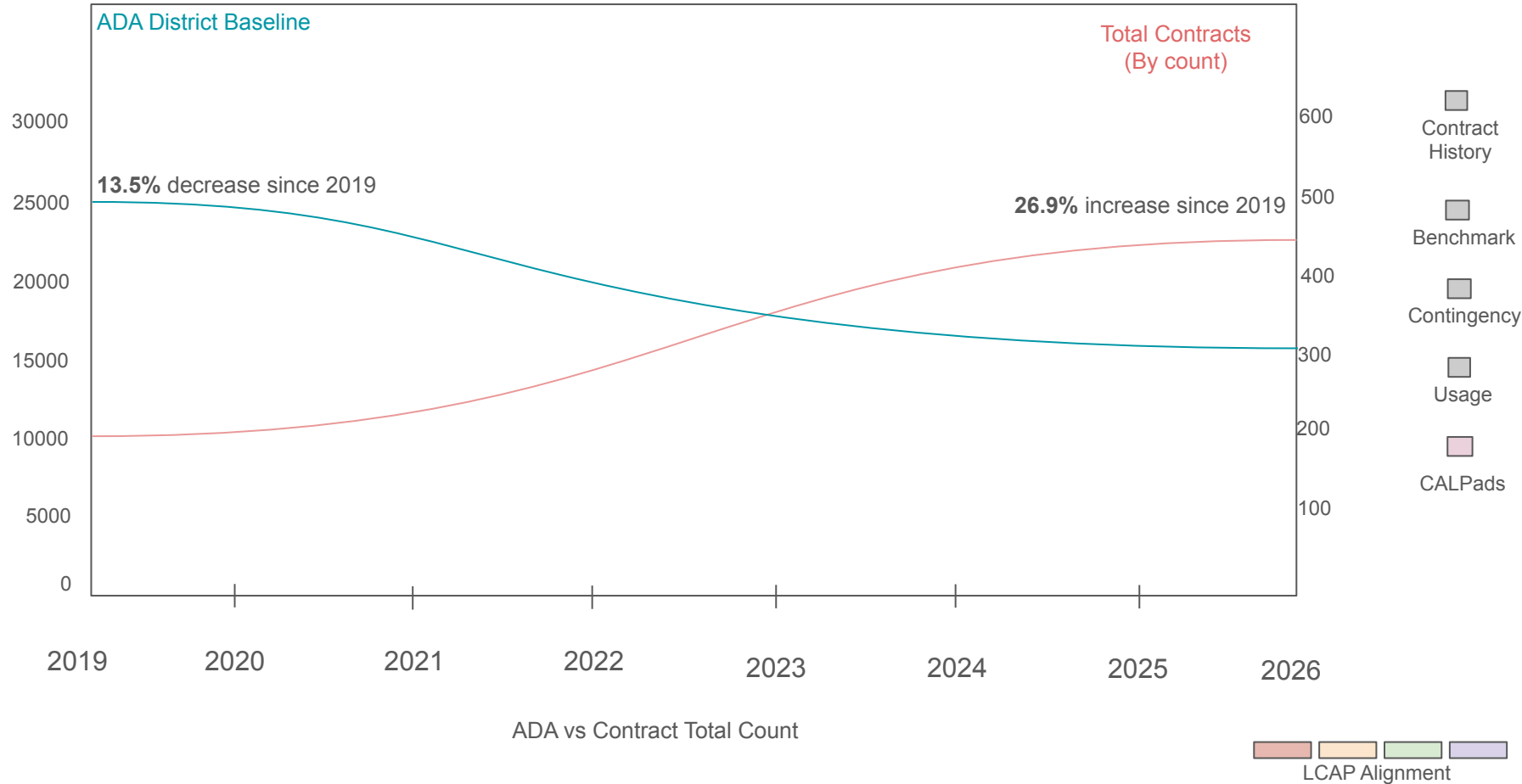
4) **Data Studies:** Salary, Competitive, Management



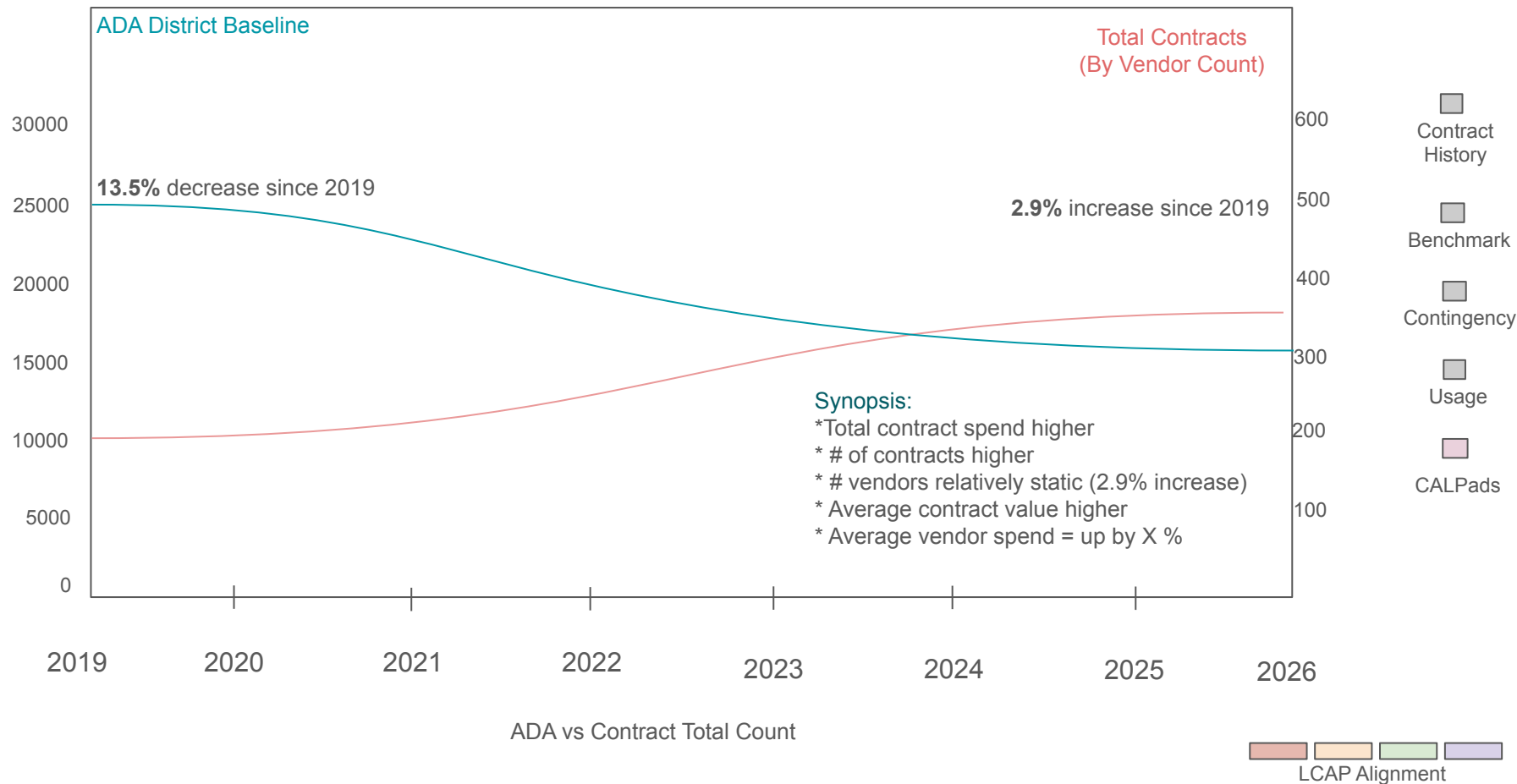
Value Delta: Baseline / Contract Spend



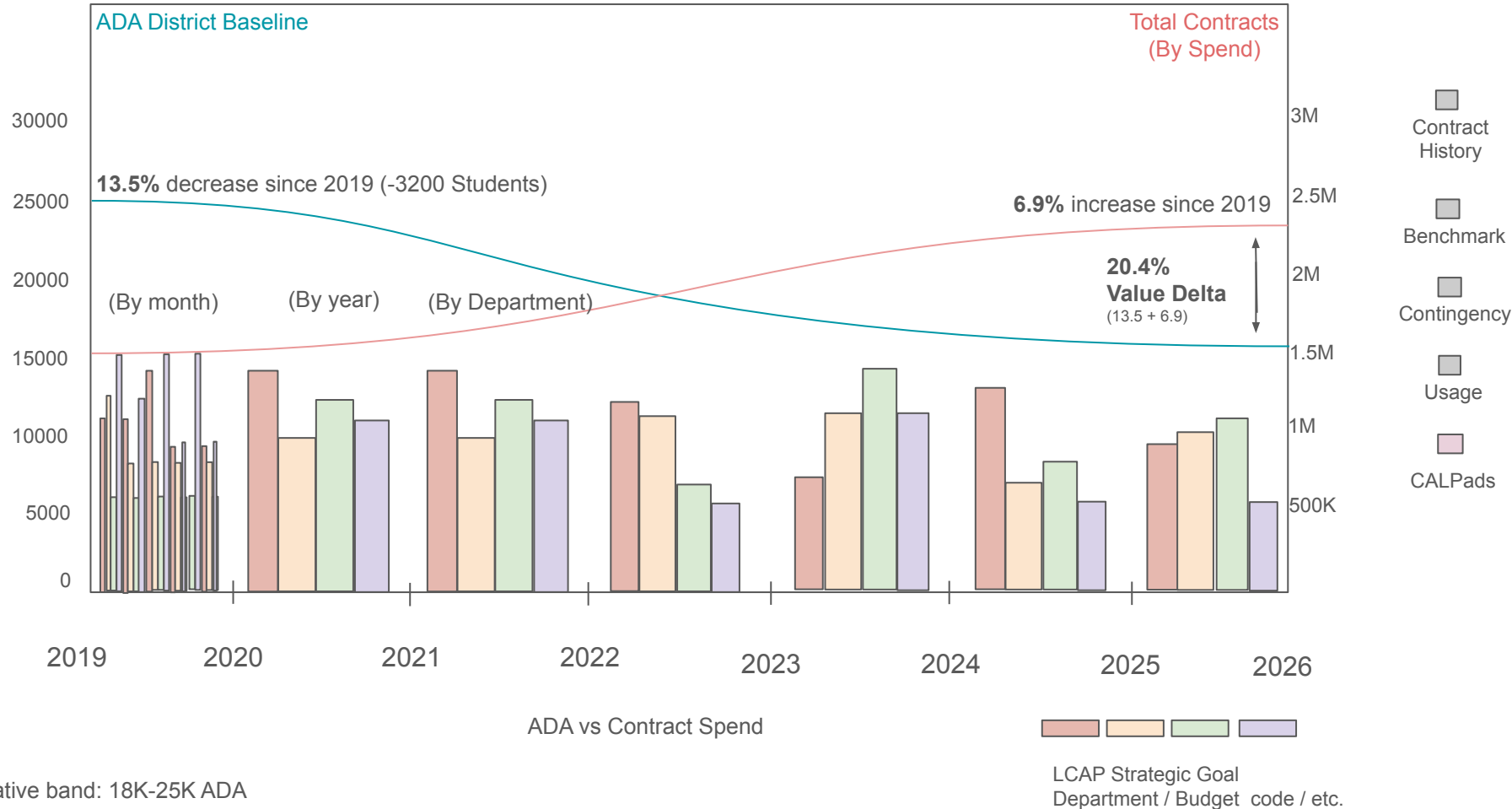
Value Delta: Baseline / Total # of Contract



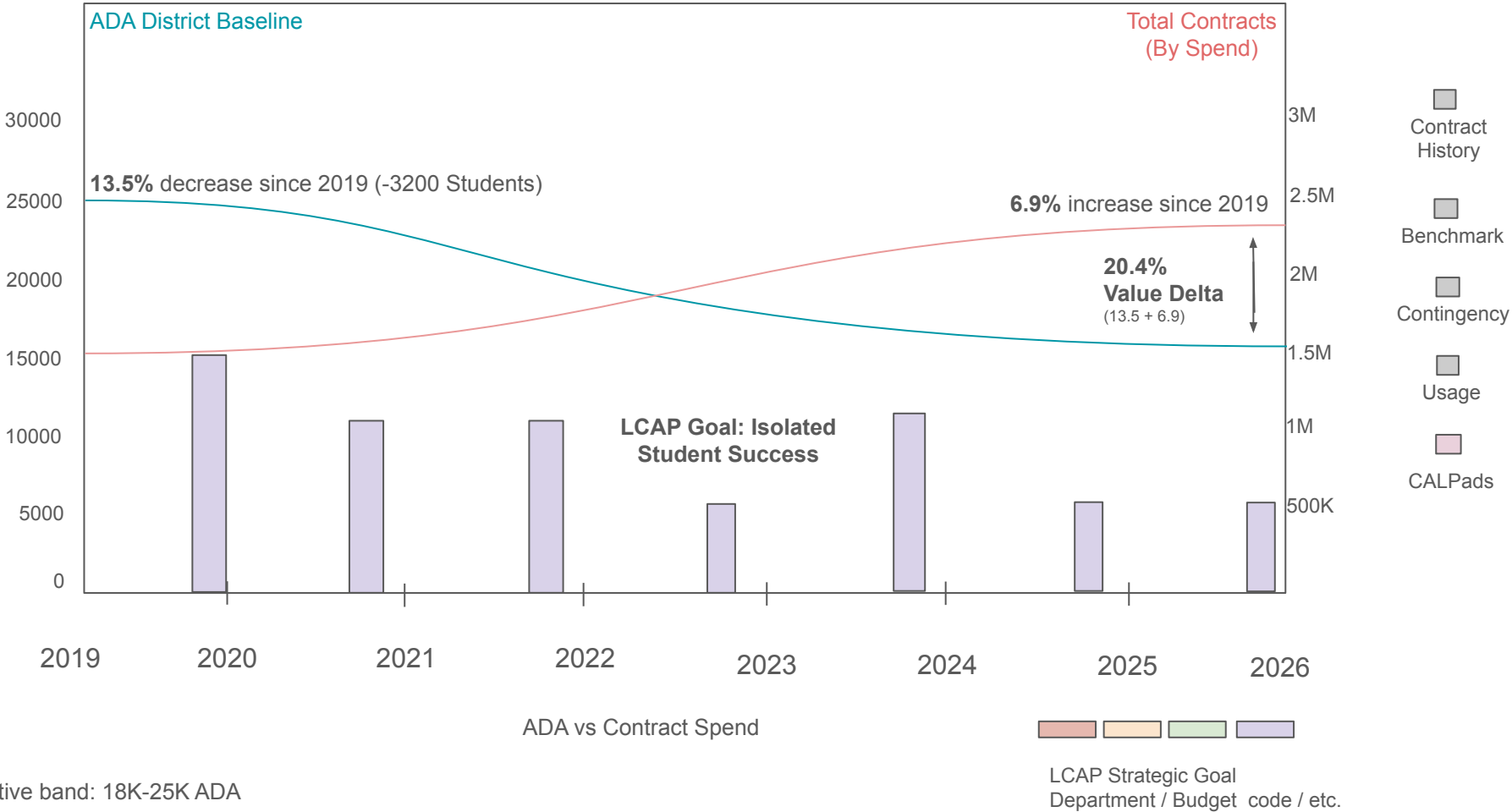
Value Delta: Baseline / Total # of Vendors



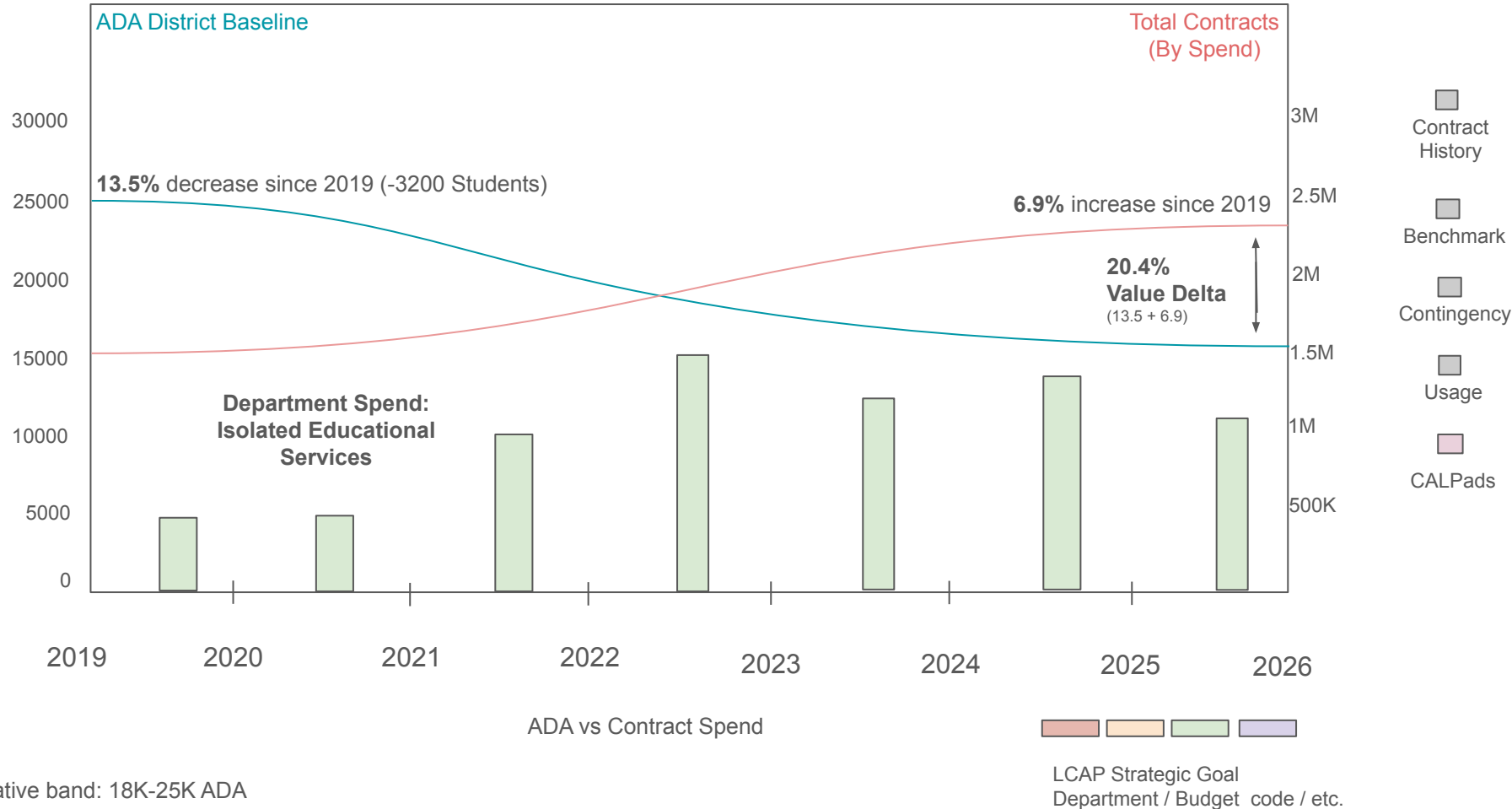
Value Delta: Baseline / Contract Spend / LCAP Alignment (YOY)



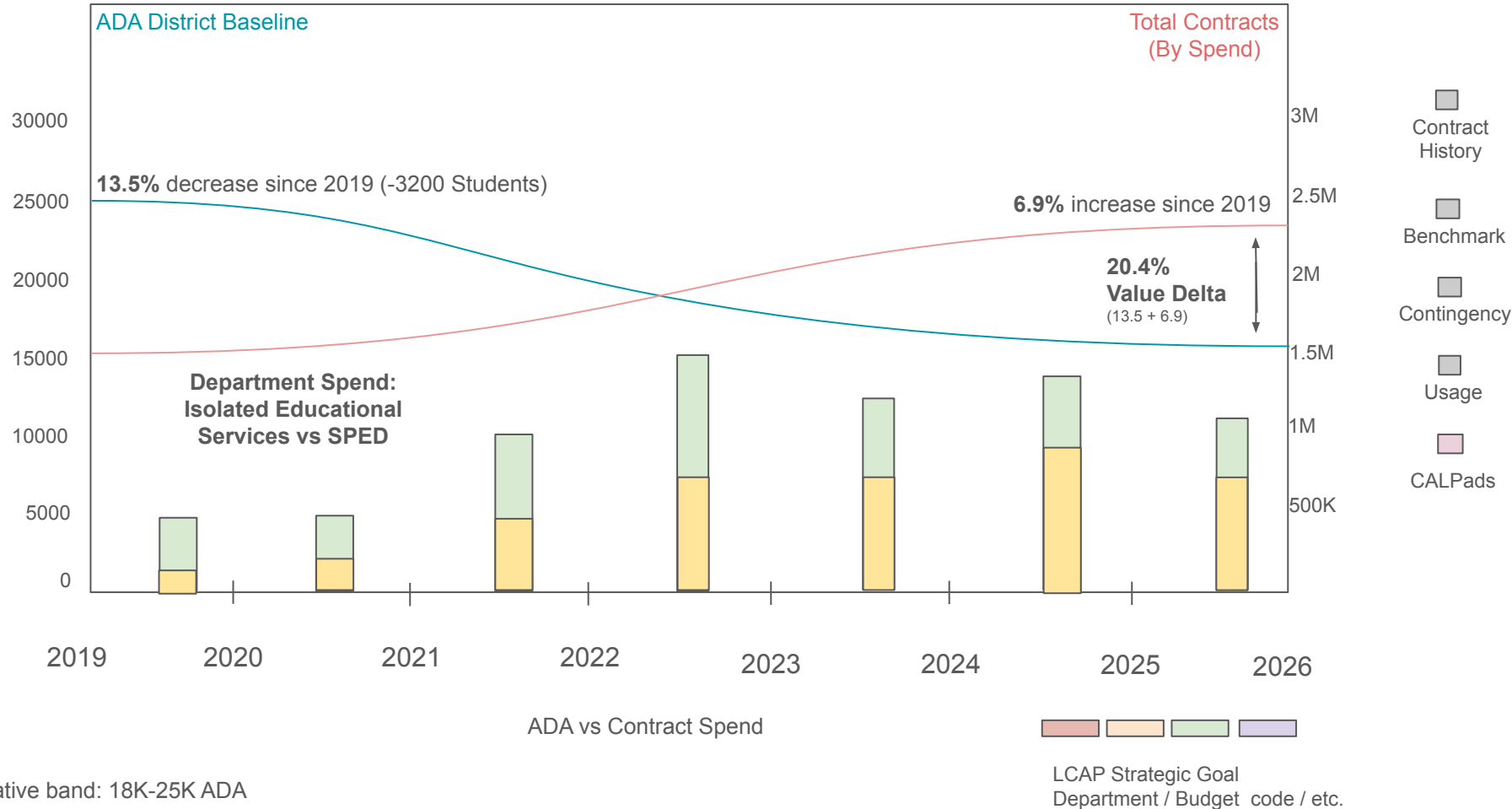
Value Delta: Baseline / Contract Spend / LCAP Alignment



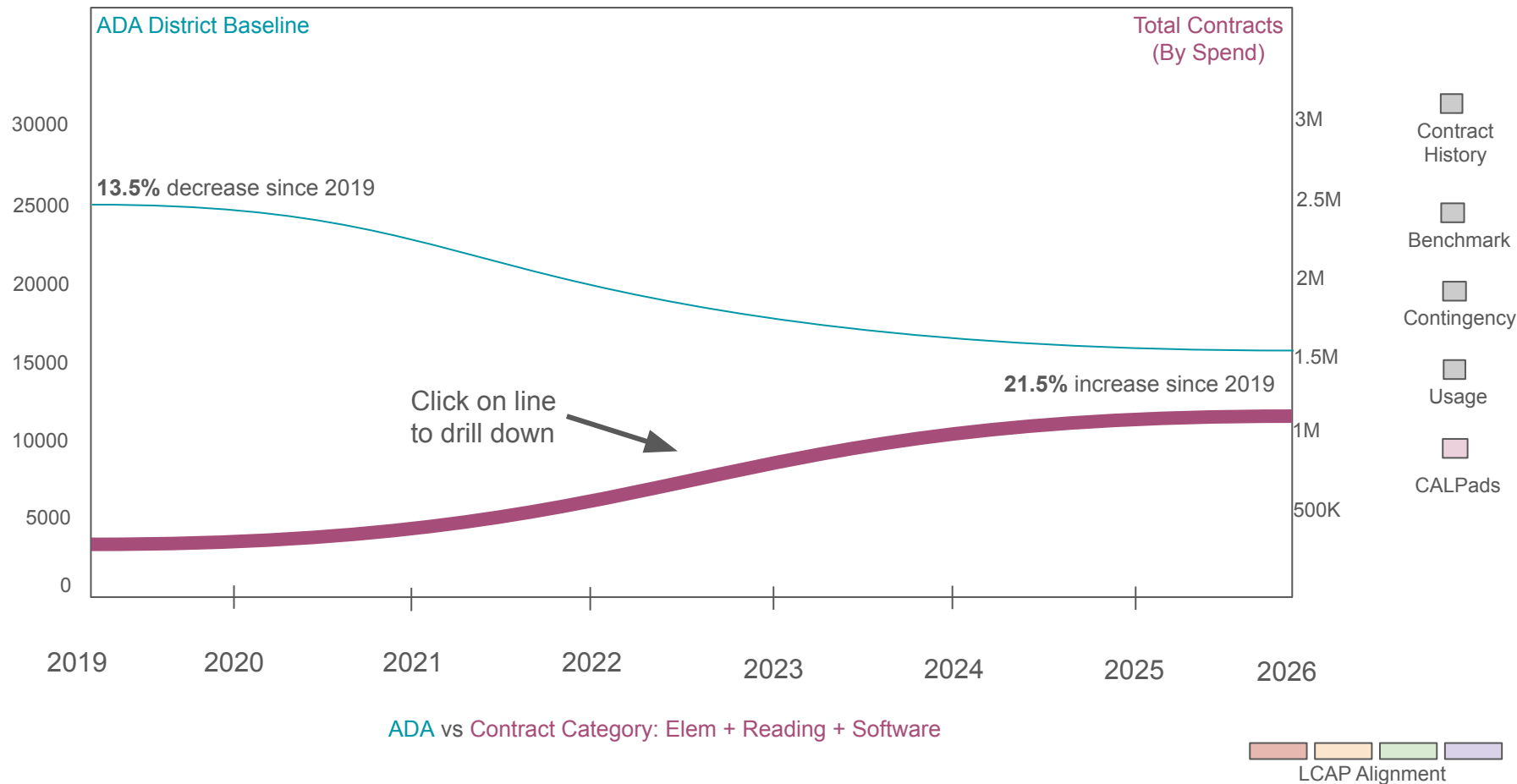
Value Delta: Baseline / Contract Spend / LCAP Alignment



Value Delta: Baseline / Contract Spend / LCAP Alignment

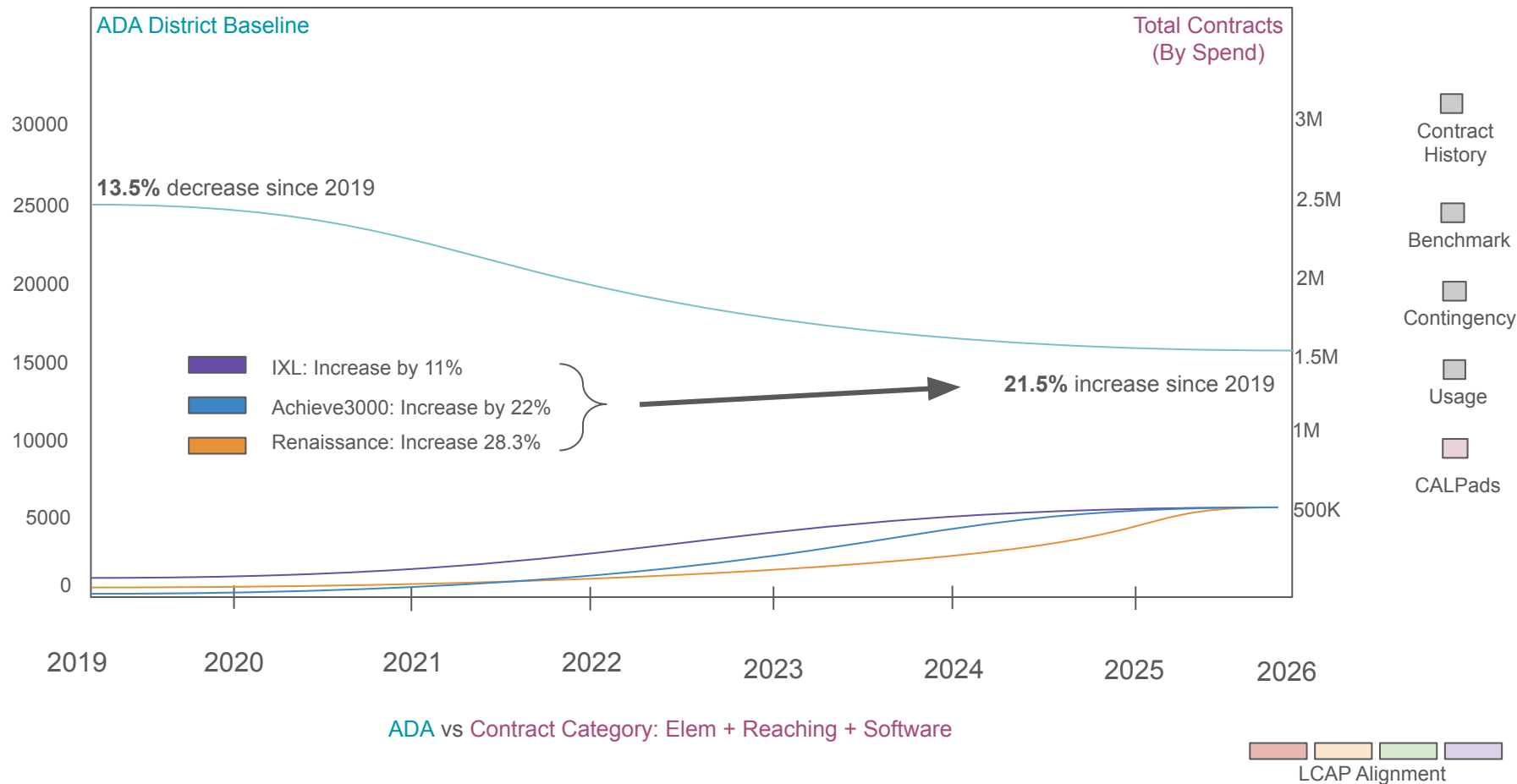


Value Delta: Category / Spend (Elem Reading Software)



Comparative band: 18K-25K ADA

Value Delta: Category / Spend (Elem Reading Software)



Value Delta: Category / Usage / Vendor (Elem Reading Software)

